Area of a Triangle

Exam code: 0607

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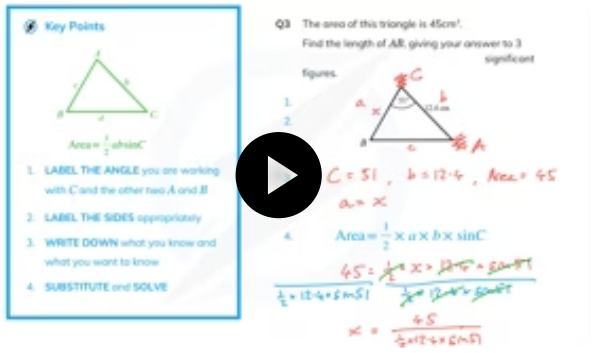

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Help me understand

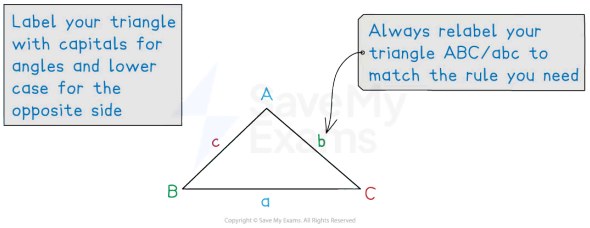
Area of a triangle

How do I find the area of a non-right-angled triangle?

- The area of **any triangle** can be found using the formula

$$\text{Area} = \frac{1}{2}ab\sin C$$

- C is the angle **between** sides a and b



- Label your triangle correctly
  - Make sure that C is always the angle **between** the two sides
- If angle C is 90°, you get a right-angled triangle
  - sin 90° = 1 so the formula becomes the familiar "Area = ½ × base × height"!

Stuck on something?
Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.
Got it

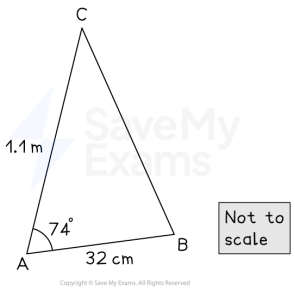
Examiner Tips and Tricks

You are given the triangle area rule on the formula sheet.

Worked Example

The following diagram shows triangle ABC.

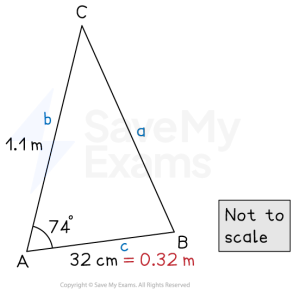
$AB = 32$ cm, $AC = 1.1$ m and angle $BAC = 74°$.



Calculate the area of triangle, giving your answer in m^2.

Answer:

Label the sides of the triangle
Convert the sides to be in the same units



Use the area of a triangle formula, $\text{Area} = \frac{1}{2}bc \sin A$

$$\text{Area} = \frac{1}{2}(1.1)(0.32) \sin 74$$
$$= 0.16918...$$

The area is 0.169 m^2 (to 3 s.f.)

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